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Professor Eyke Hüllermeier
Data Mining and Knowledge Discovery

Dear Professor Hüllermeier,

Re: revision of manuscript 1e58c388-d7ec-4084-b792-df20a48e3e75, “Baseline-Relative Predictability Horizons for Cross-Domain Forecast Evaluation.”

We thank you and the Reviewers for a careful and constructive assessment. We enclose the clean revised manuscript and a point-by-point response. The main changes are:

- **Definitions and use.** The relaxed horizon now states explicitly that non-positive steps can lie inside its span, and a new subsection explains what the relaxed and strict horizons add to fixed-horizon summaries, and what they do not establish. We discuss why using the descriptors to choose horizons dynamically would require a prospective or nested evaluation, since otherwise it risks adaptive selection bias.
- **Presentation.** Figures 1 and 2 were redrawn, all figures are cited, and units are stated.
- **Alternative baseline.** We added a seasonal-persistence sensitivity on exactly matched support for all four domains.
- **ARIMA.** The order (2, 0, 0) was fixed a priori and not selected with ACF or information criteria. We say so, report an AIC-based order diagnostic and the ACF/PACF in a new appendix, and present the check as an illustration of model-class sensitivity.

Corrections to previously reported results. In preparing the revision we found and corrected three reporting issues, all described in the response letter. (i) The $PM_{2.5}$ text reported $H^*(\text{strict}) = 13$, which came from a moving-average experiment; the plotted LightGBM curve gives 22, and the text and Table 3 now follow the curve. (ii) The wind ARIMA check had requested a one-step forecast at every horizon; the h -step rerun leaves the wind descriptors unchanged. (iii) The $PM_{2.5}$ row of the RMSE appendix was inherited from the same moving-average experiment and was recomputed ($H^*(\text{strict}) = 23$).

Additional experiments. The wind ARIMA rerun, the ARIMA order diagnostic, the RMSE recomputation (which reproduces the reported MAE exactly) and the seasonal-persistence sensitivity used the same data and protocol as the paper; no new model class, hyperparameter or split was introduced.

Data. The exact inputs of all four experiments, with SHA-256 checksums, are deposited at https://github.com/EduIntellect/paper2H/tree/data-cache-v1/release/data_cache_four_domain. For the traffic series, whose underlying measurements come from Caltrans PeMS, we state that we have not obtained separate confirmation of redistribution terms and will remove the file on request.

Thank you for the opportunity to revise our work.

Sincerely,

Federico Garcia Crespi
Corresponding author, on behalf of the
authors